

Mamdouh Alenezi, Ph.D.

Executive Leader — National AI & Data Capability Development | Technology Governance | Digital Transformation

Riyadh, Saudi Arabia · +966 555 890 580 · enezi.mamdouh@gmail.com

linkedin.com/in/mamdouhalenezi · malenezi.github.io/malenezi · x.com/MamdouhAlenezi

EXECUTIVE PROFILE

Technology and education executive with 12+ years of progressive leadership across national AI capability building, technology governance, and higher-education transformation. Currently General Manager of the SDAIA Academy, leading Saudi Arabia's national data and AI talent-development agenda in direct support of Vision 2030 and the Human Capability Development Program. Formerly Director of the AI Academy and Acting Director of Technology Governance at Tahakom, and a three-time Dean and CIO at Prince Sultan University, with a track record of raising enterprise-architecture and delivery maturity (CMMI, ISO, CI/CD-enabled DevOps), institutionalizing PMO governance, and converting national strategy into measurable programs, KPIs, and accredited learning pathways. Full Professor of Software Engineering and Prosci® Certified Change Practitioner, known for analytical rigor, high-performing teams, and responsible, outcome-driven AI adoption.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- **Strategic Leadership:** Digital transformation strategy · national AI & data strategy execution · IT governance · change management (Prosci/ADKAR) · cross-sector stakeholder alignment · executive communication
- **Operational Excellence:** Enterprise architecture · PMO & portfolio governance · program design & delivery · KPI & performance measurement · budgeting · ISO- and CMMI-based quality management
- **Technology:** Software engineering · DevOps & CI/CD · data governance & stewardship · cloud & distributed architecture · cybersecurity · high-performance computing foundations
- **Capability Building:** Curriculum & learning-program design (ABET/ACM) · professional certification frameworks · talent-pipeline development · training evaluation · academia-industry partnerships · research-to-practice translation
- **Governance, Ethics & Risk:** AI governance frameworks · responsible AI & ethics · privacy & data protection · regulatory compliance · governance audits & risk remediation

EXECUTIVE EXPERIENCE

General Manager, SDAIA Academy — Saudi Data & Artificial Intelligence Authority (SDAIA) **03/2026 – Present**
Riyadh, Saudi Arabia

- Direct Saudi Arabia's national data and AI capability-development arm, owning the strategy, portfolio, and delivery of advanced training programs, bootcamps, and professional certifications for the Kingdom's future workforce.
- Translate Vision 2030 and Human Capability Development Program priorities into a measurable academy portfolio with defined KPIs and impact metrics, strengthening training quality and workforce readiness.
- Structure and manage strategic partnerships with leading universities, research institutions, and industry to co-develop curricula, enable research translation, and scale accredited learning pathways.
- Govern academy-wide quality assurance, assessment, and certification frameworks to international standards, ensuring outcomes meet both global benchmarks and national needs.
- Champion initiatives that build a digitally empowered society and accelerate the transition to a sustainable, knowledge-based economy.

Director, AI Academy & Acting Director, Technology Governance — Tahakom **08/2024 – 03/2026**
Riyadh, Saudi Arabia

- Held dual mandate spanning enterprise-wide AI capability building and corporate technology governance for a national smart-mobility and public-safety technology company.
- Designed and institutionalized a PMO playbook governing the full project lifecycle; led governance audits, maturity assessments, and remediation roadmaps to secure project value realization.
- Raised enterprise-architecture maturity and clarified the governance operating model, aligning technology investments with corporate strategy and digital-transformation goals.
- Overhauled policies, processes, and the SDLC with CMMI-aligned quality controls, delivering measurable maturity gains; modernized the delivery pipeline with CI/CD-enabled DevOps, improving speed, traceability, and software quality.
- Built a sustained AI capability ecosystem through enterprise training programs, competency-based certifications, recurring AI townhalls, and academia-industry partnerships embedding ISO-compliant standards into smart-mobility and public-safety solutions.

Founding Dean, College of Space & Aviation Sciences — Prince Sultan University **04/2024 – 08/2024**
Riyadh, Saudi Arabia

- Established the college from inception — academic vision, governance structure, and founding program architecture — for one of the Kingdom's first dedicated space and aviation colleges.

Dean, Quality Assurance & Development — Prince Sultan University **09/2020 – 08/2024**
Riyadh, Saudi Arabia

- Led institution-wide quality strategy, securing ISO certifications and national/international academic accreditations.
- Implemented a comprehensive Quality Management System and institution-wide assessment and evaluation frameworks, embedding continuous improvement across academic and administrative units.
- Elevated teaching and learning practice through the Teaching & Learning Center, expanding faculty development programs campus-wide.

Dean, Educational Services — Prince Sultan University **09/2018 – 08/2020**
Riyadh, Saudi Arabia

- Owned the end-to-end student journey; restructured the Preparatory Year Program into an independent department, improving first-year progression and the overall student experience.
- Strengthened academic-support operations — placement testing, semester knowledge evaluations, and advising — through tighter governance of educational services.

Chief Information & Technology Officer — Prince Sultan University **01/2015 – 08/2019**
Riyadh, Saudi Arabia

- Set and executed the university-wide technology vision, aligning the IT services division with institutional strategy and measurably improving student success outcomes.
- Delivered an institution-wide ERP implementation across finance, accounting, and HR, streamlining core administrative processes.
- Established a continuous IT planning process serving faculty, staff, and students, embedding a culture of innovation and digital transformation.

Chairman, Department of Computer Science — Prince Sultan University **09/2015 – 08/2016**
Riyadh, Saudi Arabia

- Redesigned the curriculum to IEEE, ACM, and ABET standards, broadening course and degree offerings and incorporating structured employer feedback to keep programs industry-relevant.

CONSULTING & FUNDED RESEARCH (SELECTED)

Strategic Planning Consultant — CYBEX, Prince Sultan University **11/2023 – Present**
Riyadh, Saudi Arabia

- Advise on strategy formulation end-to-end: methodology selection, multi-stakeholder workshops, and full documentation of vision, mission, goals, and initiatives.

Software Engineering Consultant — Prince Sultan Defense Studies & Research Center (PSDSARC) **02/2023 – 02/2024**
Riyadh, Saudi Arabia

- Provided software-engineering expertise and technology recommendations that improved the efficiency of research and analysis workflows.

Principal Investigator, Funded Research — King Abdulaziz City for Science & Technology (KACST) **01/2017 – 12/2018**
Riyadh, Saudi Arabia

- Designed a dynamic capacity-provisioning system for cloud networks, applying machine learning to auto-scale resources against demand — improving network efficiency and reducing operational cost.

Data Science Consultant — Major Saudi Telecom Operator **01/2016 – 09/2016**
Riyadh, Saudi Arabia

- Led root-cause analysis of repeated customer-service tickets and implemented corrective measures, significantly reducing ticket recurrence and lifting customer satisfaction.

- Led the migration of an enterprise billing-management system from client-server architecture to web services, reducing operational costs and improving the customer experience.

EDUCATION

Ph.D., Software Engineering , North Dakota State University <i>Fargo, ND, USA</i>	2011 – 2014
M.S., Software Engineering , DePaul University <i>Chicago, IL, USA</i>	2010 – 2011
B.S., Computer Science , Prince Sultan University <i>Riyadh, Saudi Arabia</i>	2005 – 2010

CERTIFICATIONS & EXECUTIVE EDUCATION

- **Prosci® Certified Change Practitioner** — Prosci (2025): change management, ADKAR, organizational transformation
- **Strategy Specialization** — Harvard Business School Online (2024): Strategy Execution, Sustainable Business Strategy, Disruptive Strategy

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

• Full Professor of Software Engineering , Prince Sultan University	2022 – 2024
• Associate Professor of Software Engineering , Prince Sultan University	2018 – 2022
• Assistant Professor of Software Engineering , Prince Sultan University	2014 – 2018

SELECTED ACADEMIC LEADERSHIP & SERVICE

- **Curriculum development:** Designed the B.S. in Software Engineering, M.S. in Software Engineering, and M.S. in Cybersecurity Engineering programs; created a Digital Transformation track and six new courses spanning DevOps engineering, software construction, requirements engineering, secure software engineering, and software entrepreneurship.
- **Conference leadership:** General/Conference Chair of three international conferences on data science and machine learning applications (SDMA 2018; CDMA 2020, 2024); program-committee member for 13+ international conferences, including IEEE ICMLA, ICSEA, and ENASE.
- **Editorial service:** Reviewer for 11 indexed journals, including *ACM Computing Surveys*, *Information and Software Technology*, and *Education and Information Technologies*.
- **Institutional governance:** Served on eight university-level committees, including Strategic Planning, ABET Steering, Institutional Effectiveness, and Executive Quality & Planning.